

- **Informed Immigrant:** <https://www.informedimmigrant.com/>
- **Immigrant Legal Resource Center (ILRC):** <https://www.ilrc.org/community-resources>
- **National Immigration Law Center (NILC):** <https://www.nilc.org/get-involved/community-education-resources/know-your-rights/>

Documents You Should and Should Not Carry With You

- At all times, carry a valid work permit or green card, if you have one. If you do not have one, generally it is advisable to carry a municipal ID, state ID or driver's license if it was issued in the United States and contains no information at all about your immigration status or your country of origin. Ask a local immigration advocate about what kind of documents are safe to carry in your area.
- At all times, carry a red card to exercise your right to remain silent in case you are stopped or interrogated by ICE or police officers.
- At all times, carry the telephone number of an immigration lawyer, advocate or nonprofit immigration legal services provider you will call in an emergency.
- Do not carry any documentation about your country of origin.
- Do not carry any false identity documents or false immigration documents.

➞ Make a Plan for Your Child(ren)

Have a plan so that a trusted adult can care for your child if you cannot. This plan should include emergency numbers, a list of important contact information, specific legal authorization documents for the care of your child(ren) and a file with important documents. This packet includes templates to put together these documents.

➞ Talk to Your Children About Your Plan

Without worrying them, assure your children that they will be taken care of if for some reason you are unable to care for them, even for a short period of time. Let them know who will care for them if you are unable to.

➞ Decide Who Can Care for Your Children if You Are Unable To

Talk to the people you would want to care for your children if you are unable to and make sure they know they will be listed as emergency contacts. Memorize their phone numbers and have your children memorize the phone numbers too.

Make sure your children know who can pick them from up school, who cannot pick them up from school, and who will care for them. Make sure you add the names of the emergency contacts to your school's list of adults authorized to pick up your children.

Your child's school may only release your child to adults you designate. Therefore, make sure to regularly update all school, afterschool, day care, summer camp, and other programs' emergency contact sheets and

release forms to include the names of those who can and cannot pick up your children. If you have a restraining order against anyone, make sure to give a copy of it to the school.

Make sure the people who can pick up and care for your children are up to date on your child's location and school.

➡ **Write Down Instructions if Your Child Has Any Medical Conditions and /or Takes Any Medications**

Make sure to write down any medical conditions or allergies your child has, any medications that your child takes, as well as doctor and health insurance information. Keep a copy of this information in your important documents file. Give a copy to your child's school and the adult you designate to care for your children. Let your child know where to find this information if you are not around.

➡ **Complete Caregiver Authorization Forms Included in this Packet (See "RI Forms" section at the end of this packet)**

The following authorization forms will provide evidence of your wishes as they relate to the care of your child or children if you can no longer care for them. It is advisable to complete these forms with an attorney, if possible. All forms are attached at the end of this packet.

- 1) Parental Authorization/Appointment of Guardian
- 2) Authorization for Release of Educational Records and Appointment of Guardian
- 3) Power of Attorney for Healthcare

➡ **Make Sure Your Children All Have Passports**

If your child was born in the United States, visit www.travel.state.gov for more information on obtaining a U.S. passport.

If your child was born in your home country, check with your embassy or consulate for more information on obtaining a passport.

➡ **Inform Your Family and Emergency Contacts About How to Find You if You Are Detained by ICE**

Family members can use the ICE detainee locator: <https://locator.ice.gov/odls/homePage.do>. Be sure your family and emergency contacts have a copy of your A-Number (your alien registration number found on your immigration documents from ICE) if you have one.

Want to Do Even More?

You can also **register your child's birth** with your country's government (for example, with your country's consulate) if your child was born in the United States. This may grant your child benefits, including citizenship in your home country in some cases.

Family Preparedness Important Documents Checklist

Keep these documents or a copy of these documents in a safe place. Tell your children, family members and emergency caregiver where to find this file in an emergency.

Guardianship Documentation:

- ☐ Parental Authorization/Appointment of Guardian
- ☐ Authorization for Release of Educational Records and Appointment of Guardian
- ☐ Power of Attorney for Healthcare

Other Important Documentation:

- ☐ Photo ID (driver's license, state/municipal identification card, etc.) for both parents and each child
- ☐ Birth Certificates and/or Registry of Birth for both parents and each child
- ☐ Passports for both parents and each child
- ☐ Social Security Card or ITIN number for both parents and each child
- ☐ A-Number and any immigration documents (work permit, green card, visa, etc.) for both parents and each child
- ☐ Marriage License (if applicable)
- ☐ Divorce certificate (if applicable)
- ☐ Family court orders (visitation, custody, etc., if applicable)
- ☐ Restraining Orders you/your child(ren) have against anyone (if applicable)
- ☐ Criminal papers (if applicable)
- ☐ DCYF papers (if applicable)
- ☐ Completed Important Children's Information document for each child
- ☐ Completed Emergency Numbers and Important Contact Information document

You may also include any other documents you would want to be able to find quickly.